

IIRSM Course Approval — Full Submission Brief

eLearning Application (No Trainer) | Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting | Ground Level | Version 1.4

SECTION 1 | Course Identity & Operational Specification

Official Course Title	Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting (Ground Level Framework)
Course Format	eLearning — Progressive Web Application (PWA) combined with an integrated printed manual; no trainer required
Publisher	Overleaf Publishers Ltd
Course Author / Content Developer	David J Daniel
Copyright	Copyright © 2026 Overleaf Publishers Ltd. All rights reserved. First Edition: July 2026
Platform URL	chainsawcourses.com
Contact Email	info@chainsawcourses.com
Postal Address	69 Newstead Avenue, Orpington, BR6 9RW
NOS Alignment	Independently mapped to UK National Occupational Standards (NOS) for Chainsaw Operations
NPTC Alignment	Assessment criteria independently mapped to City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 unit parameters for theoretical reference and CPD purposes only
CPD Points Awarded	5 Verifiable CPD Points
Guided Learning Hours (GLH)	16 Hours — technical text, annotated diagrams, and seven sequential video modules
Directed Online Assessment	1.5 Hours — 45-question randomised multiple-choice examination
Independent Self-Study	1.5 Hours — risk evaluation practice, glossary review, and field tool exercises
Total Qualification Time (TQT)	19 Hours total
Minimum Pass Threshold	80% or higher on the summative examination — unlimited resit attempts permitted
Target Learner Profile	Commercial chainsaw operators, forestry workers, arborists, estate and grounds teams, and landscape professionals
Course Version	Version 1.4 — submitted for initial IIRSM eLearning Course Approval (1 course)
Approval Category	New to IIRSM Course Approval — eLearning (no trainer)

SECTION 2 | Developer & Author Credentials

IIRSM requires full details of who developed the course and their level of knowledge and skills to do so. The following provides a complete account of the author's qualifications, experience, and subject-matter expertise relevant to this submission.

Author Name	David J Daniel
Role	Course Author, Content Developer & Platform Publisher
Organisation	Overleaf Publishers Ltd
Chainsaw Qualification	City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 — Chainsaw Maintenance and Cross Cutting (certificated)
First Aid Certification	Current First Aid at Work certificate held
Industry Experience	Over 27 years in the arboricultural and forestry industry. Worked as an arboricultural contract climber for numerous large and small companies throughout this period, gaining extensive hands-on operational experience across a wide range of site conditions and chainsaw applications.
Assessor & Instructor Qualifications	City & Guilds NPTC Assessor and LANTRA Instructor and Assessor for 8 years — covering practical chainsaw assessment and vocational training delivery to industry standard.
Published Author	Author of 'The Chainsaw Manual' — currently sold as a standalone physical learning aid to various colleges and training providers across the UK. The manual underpins the theoretical content of this eLearning course.
Subject Research	Course content developed with reference to current UK HSE guidance, NPTC 0039-20 unit standards, and the Overleaf Chainsaw Manual (published reference text)
Platform Development	Full-stack eLearning platform designed, developed and operated by author — Progressive Web Application with device-locked access, video streaming, and automated assessment
CPD Status	Author holds current CPD membership and engages in ongoing professional development in chainsaw safety and vocational eLearning design

SECTION 3 | Learning Outcomes & Assessment Criteria

The course is structured across seven sequential video modules, each mapped to a discrete learning outcome. Learners must complete each module video in full and achieve 80% or higher on the associated module quiz before the next module unlocks. A final summative examination of 45 randomised questions is required for certification.

Module	Learning Outcome
Equipment List	Identify and describe the personal protective equipment (PPE) and tools required for safe chainsaw operation
PPE & First Aid	Demonstrate knowledge of appropriate PPE standards and first-aid procedures relevant to chainsaw injury
5 Steps to Risk Assessment	Apply the HSE five-step risk assessment framework to chainsaw operations
Hazards & Risks	Identify site-specific hazards and evaluate risk levels using likelihood and severity matrices
Emergency Planning Information	Develop and communicate an emergency action plan for chainsaw operations on site
Law & Legislation	Describe the legal framework governing chainsaw use including PUWER and HSE guidance
Chainsaw Safety Features	Identify and explain the function of all primary chainsaw safety features and their activation mechanisms

SECTION 4 | Course Delivery & Technical Specification

Delivery Platform	Progressive Web Application (PWA) — accessible via modern web browsers on desktop, tablet, and mobile
Access Control	Single-use device-locked activation code; code bonds to first device on activation — prevents sharing
Video Hosting	Vimeo Pro — encrypted streaming; watermark overlays display learner name and email dynamically
Assessment Engine	Server-side randomised question bank; results stored in PostgreSQL database with full audit trail
Digital Waiver	Touch/mouse signature capture on first login — legally binding acknowledgement of course terms
Certificate Issuance	Automated PDF certificate issued on passing the final examination — emailed to learner
Data Security	All data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3); hosted on Replit deployment infrastructure (EU region)
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA compliant colour contrast; keyboard navigable; screen-reader compatible markup
Browser Support	Chrome 120+, Safari 16+, Firefox 120+, Edge 120+
Companion Manual	Overleaf Chainsaw Manual (printed) — supplied separately; referenced throughout the digital course

SECTION 5 | Quality Assurance & Review Process

Content accuracy is assured through the following quality control measures:

- All module content cross-referenced against current HSE Chainsaw guidance (HSE AFAG series) and City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 unit specifications.
- Quiz questions reviewed by the author against published assessment criteria and common examiner focus areas.
- Platform functionality tested across all supported browsers and device types prior to launch.
- Annual content review scheduled — first review due July 2027.
- Learner feedback captured post-examination and monitored for accuracy and relevance signals.
- Any changes to UK legislation or HSE guidance will trigger an unscheduled content review within 30 days of publication.